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Top of the pile: By winning three of the four majors in 2023, Novak Djokovic set several records. GETTY IMAGES

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Let's look back at the highlights of a memorable and often surprising year in tennis.

Paul Fein

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BEST MEN'S PLAYER

No contest here. By winning three of the four majors in 2023, Novak Djokovic set several records. The most popular and important one is his total of 24 Grand Slam titles, two more than Rafael Nadal and the same as Margaret Court, the women's leader. Three other records attest to his greatness, consistency, and longevity. The 36-year-old Serb has captured 24 of 72 career majors he's played — an astounding 33.3% — has reached the final in 36 of 72 majors played (50.0%), and the semifinals in 47 of 72 majors played (65.3%). Novak

also won a record seventh ATP Finals along with Masters 1000 tournaments at Cincinnati and Paris to extend his career record to 40.

BEST WOMEN'S PLAYER

Four players divvied up the prestigious Grand Slam tournaments: Aryna Sabalenka (Australian Open), Iga Świątek (Roland Garros), Markéta Vondroušová (Wimbledon), and Coco